ADELAIDE / INVESTOR PLAN / 2026

Better orders. *Less waste.*

Predictive food-cost software for independent cafes. A measured path from daily uncertainty to an investable business.

Plan word count: 1,652 (including figure text)

01 **The business**

A daily decision worth paying for

> **Evidence basis.** Customer research is teacher-approved classroom simulation. Financials are assumptions. External sources are cited. Partnerships remain proposed.

Australia's 2021 food-waste study estimated 7.6 million tonnes wasted annually.[1] ClearPlate targets the owner whose fear of selling out encourages excess production. The customer needs a dependable quantity decision before opening, with less administration at closing. Our vision is affordable waste prevention; our values are measurable savings, safe redistribution and customer control.

The AT2 simulation gave over-ordering 27 of 42 selections but leftover logistics only six. Five simulated owner interviews suggested that avoiding empty cabinets outweighed donation convenience. This supports the first pivot: predictive ordering becomes the paid benefit. However, the small simulated sample cannot establish willingness to pay. Three pilot venues must demonstrate repeat use before acquisition spending expands.

The simulation separates operators ordering from memory from those maintaining inconsistent spreadsheets. Both need confidence, but their onboarding differs: guided setup for the first group and CSV import for the second. Recruiting digitally hesitant owners into the pilot tests whether convenience survives beyond technology enthusiasts.



FIG 01 AT2 simulated responses. Expense selections were multiple-choice.

ClearPlate combines sales, recipe costs and short closing counts with weather to recommend tomorrow's production. Sales alone cannot distinguish waste from stockouts. The revised prototype therefore records both, displays forecast ranges and leaves approval with the owner. A mobile dashboard delivers the service; cafes retain responsibility for food handling.

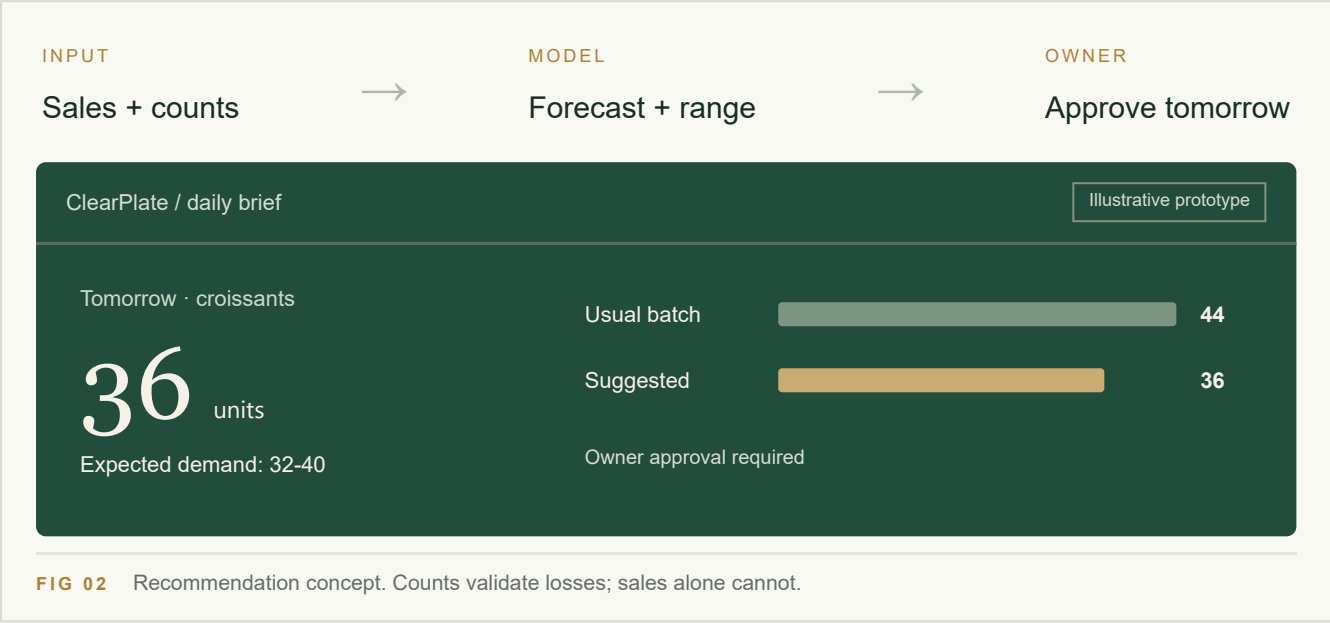


FIG 02 Recommendation concept. Counts validate losses; sales alone cannot.

A proposed Adelaide proprietary limited company would operate remotely, using cloud hosting and existing cafe devices. The founder retains product and financial control, with contracted development and partnership support. Code ownership and confidentiality belong in development contracts; a trade mark protects the brand. Cyber and professional indemnity cover require quotations before launch.

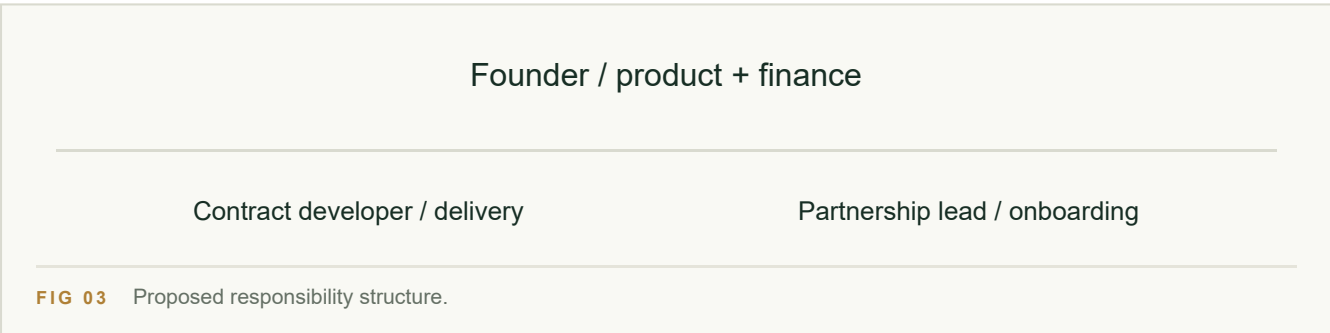


FIG 03 Proposed responsibility structure.

02 **The market**

A focused entry into a capable market

The initial segment is independent cafes and bakeries with repeatable menus and digital sales records. Their practical alternative is experienced judgement supported by spreadsheets. MarketMan already markets predictive inventory tools; Square offers ingredient costing through MarketMan. [2] [3] This corrects the earlier claim that competitors lack prediction. Our testable advantage is a simpler daily decision plus coordinated surplus handling, rather than a unique algorithm.

ALTERNATIVE	ESTABLISHED STRENGTH	CLEARPLATE RESPONSE
MarketMan	Forecasting	Faster daily decisions
Square / MarketMan	Ingredient costing	Small-cafe workflow
Spreadsheet	Low cash cost	Automatic imports

FIG 04 Positioning from supplier documentation [2, 3]. Differentiation requires testing.

The earlier 1,150-venue market estimate lacked a verified source. A bottom-up acquisition model instead requires 400 qualified prospects across Adelaide precincts. Figure 5 exposes the conversion assumptions behind 62 retained venues. Roaster referrals concentrate outreach, but dependence on one referrer would restrict growth. Direct demonstrations provide a second channel.



FIG 05 Year-one acquisition assumptions, including eight exits.

Monthly tiers remain Sprout $49 for measurement, Growth $89 for prediction and Harvest $149 for coordination and reporting. OzHarvest already offers free collection and impact reporting, so donation alone cannot justify Harvest. [4] Its premium must save reconciliation time. Donation access remains available to all venues; charities pay nothing. A 14-day audit acquires customers, weekly savings reports support retention and upgrades follow demonstrated value.

Retention should come from repeatable savings rather than trapped data. Customers can export records and cancel monthly. Track trial conversion separately from satisfaction: enthusiasm without payment would require cheaper delivery or a narrower segment, not a larger advertising budget.

03 **The strategy**

Validation before expansion

The eight-week pilot uses two baseline weeks followed by six intervention weeks across three venues. Compare ingredient cost per $100 of comparable sales, controlling for price changes and product mix. The commercial hurdle is an 8% reduction without increased stockouts, alongside daily entry below two minutes and two venues committing to pay. The earlier 15% saving becomes a stretch hypothesis. A short pilot cannot establish seasonal performance.

M1	M2-3	M4-9	M10-12
Instrument	Validate	Acquire	Consolidate
Counts + consent	Three-venue pilot	Monthly retention review	49+ paying venues

FIG 06 Launch follows validation. Regional expansion remains conditional.

The founder reviews forecasts and retention monthly. If the pilot misses its hurdles, retain measurement, revise recommendations and defer expansion. Year two targets a second region only after three consecutive months of positive operating cash and monthly customer churn below 3%. A decision log connects each result to changes in product scope and spending.

Digital opportunity and exposure

Cloud delivery supports recurring revenue across locations, but support and processing costs rise with usage. Shared learning may improve forecasts only when menus are comparable and venues consent. Hold-out testing must beat a simple same-weekday average before recommending production. An override records the reason for disagreement, making owner expertise a source of learning rather than an obstacle.

During cold start, the platform offers a descriptive audit until sufficient history exists. A low-confidence forecast retains the owner's established quantity. This sacrifices early automation to reduce lost sales and protects trust while the model learns.

Platform dependency is the main digital threat: an API change can interrupt recommendations. Launch with one integration plus CSV fallback; fund a second only after demand validation. Cached history maintains visibility during outages. Tenant separation, encryption and export rights support trust, with personal data minimised under an Australian Privacy Principles approach.[5] These controls matter more initially than speculative network effects.

Impacts and operating safeguards

PESTLE analysis identifies cost pressure as both motivation to save and resistance to another subscription. SWOT identifies limited development capacity against capable incumbents. Together these findings favour a narrow pilot over simultaneous integrations. Donor protection sits in section 74A of the Civil Liability Act 1936, not section 74; it excludes donors knowingly or recklessly supplying unsafe food.[6] Logs support accountability but cannot guarantee immunity.

The second pivot replaces assumed instant pickups with capacity-confirmed collection windows. OzHarvest's published guidance notes that excess bread can be difficult to redistribute.[4] Local recipient acceptance therefore precedes matching; no partnership is claimed. Time, temperature and allergen records support safe handover under applicable food standards.[7] Unsuitable surplus goes to an approved organics stream.

PREVENT *then* DONATE *then* COMPOST

FIG 07 Track avoided purchasing and accepted donations separately.

Prevention avoids purchasing impacts before disposal occurs. Donation offers immediate social benefit, but shrinking surplus is evidence of successful prevention, not failure. Report avoided purchases separately from accepted kilograms; never convert them into claimed meals or emissions without a defensible method. Grouped collections may reduce travel, but transport impacts must be measured. Recipient dignity and requested food quality outweigh promotional donation totals.

04 **The finance**

A forecast that includes the downside

Seek $48,000 for an indicative 12% equity share: a $400,000 post-investment valuation subject to negotiation. Allocate $22,000 to the build, $5,000 to the pilot and $21,000 to operating liquidity. Negotiate milestone-based development payments; the forecast conservatively pays the build upfront. Capital remains at risk; failed validation pauses further commitments rather than promising automatic refunds.

A 50/35/15 tier mix produces $78 monthly revenue per venue. Allow $10 for usage, payments and support, leaving $68 contribution. Fixed costs of $3,315 comprise maintenance $2,500, cloud $180, tools $150, marketing $400 and insurance $85. These are planning allowances requiring quotations. Figure 8 corrects the earlier 43-customer estimate, which omitted variable costs.

Accounts are billed monthly in advance; the model assumes a stable tier mix and no bad debts. Cloud setup is included in the build. Build and pilot outflows are separate from maintenance. GST registration and cash treatment require confirmation before trading; no tax refund funds the forecast.

Pricing mix also matters. If average revenue falls to $65, contribution drops to $55 and break-even rises to 61 venues. Test willingness to upgrade before discounting; subscriber growth alone can conceal weakening economics.

$78	–	$10	=	$68
Revenue/venue		Variable cost		Contribution

$3,315 ÷ $68 = 48.75 → 49 venues

FIG 08 Monthly operating break-even, before founder salaries.

The forecast assumes no subscriptions during M1-3 and monthly billing from M4. It reaches 49-customer operating break-even in M10 and 62 venues by M12. Year-one revenue is $26,364 and the operating loss is $16,796 before build and pilot spending. Monthly break-even therefore does not repay startup capital. Founder drawings remain zero throughout year one; adding $1,500 monthly remuneration raises break-even to 71 venues.

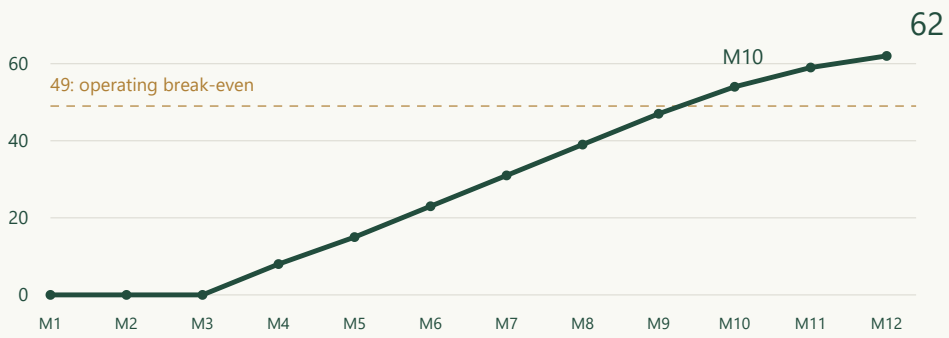


FIG 09 Base forecast: billed venues after exits. M1-3 have no subscription income.

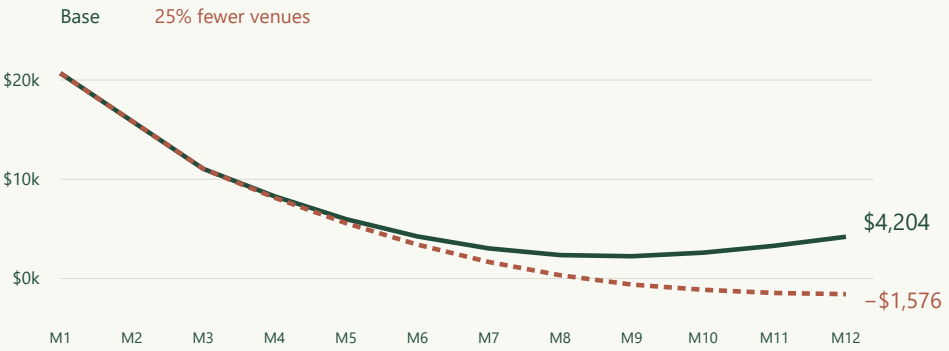


FIG 10 Closing cash after investment, build and pilot. Downside excludes corrective action.

Revenue	$26,364
Fixed operating costs	−$39,780
Variable operating costs	−$3,380
Operating loss	**−$16,796**
Build + pilot	−$27,000
Equity funding	$48,000
Closing cash	**$4,204**

FIG 11 Year-one cash budget. Planning estimates in AUD.

Base cash bottoms at $2,249 in M9 and closes at $4,204. With 25% fewer venues, cash becomes negative in M9. If M6 has fewer than 23 paying venues, renegotiate maintenance down $500 monthly from M7 and suspend expansion. This depends on supplier agreement and leaves little reserve. Secure funding or stop commitments before cash is exhausted. Grants are excluded.

For a cafe purchasing $10,000 of ingredients monthly, an illustrative 8% reduction yields $800 before fees, or $711 after Growth. This is a scenario, not a pilot result. The investment case is conditional: validate savings without lost sales, prove repeat usage and preserve cash before pursuing scale.

References

External sources accessed 14 October 2026. Classroom research and forecast assumptions are identified in the plan.

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